Diversion of Pseudoephedrine capsules through Pipavav Port, Gujarat

CASE STUDY - 08

Name of the Drug : Pseudoephedrine **Qty. Seized : 39,60,000 capsules (475.2 kg Pseudoephedrine HCL**

NCB Zonal Unit : Ahmedabad Zonal Unit **Total Arrest : 02 Persons**

Intelligence and sampling

- Acting on specific input, NCB Ahmedabad searched container No. TCLU5702630 at Pipavav Port and took batch-wise samples of medicines claimed or suspected to contain Pseudoephedrine. The first sample from each batch was sent to the National Forensic Science University, Gandhinagar for chemical analysis.

Seizure

- After the NFSU report confirmed the intelligence concerning diversion of Pseudoephedrine, NCB Ahmedabad seized fake capsules contained in the container, totaling 39,60,000 capsules. The declaration stated that each capsule contained 120 mg of Pseudoephedrine HCL, indicating diversion of 475.2 kg of Pseudoephedrine HCL.

Investigation and arrests

- The investigation found that the medicines were manufactured and exported by M/s 'X' to South Sudan. The Director, Authorized Chief Chemist and Store Incharge of M/s 'X' were arrested for their involvement and alleged contravention of Sections 9A, 25A, 26, 29 and 38 of the NDPS Act.

1.5 PRECURSOR CHEMICALS

Precursor Chemicals are dual use chemicals that have legitimate uses, and can also be used in the manufacture of illicit narcotic drugs and psychotropic substances.

Trends:

- Ephedrine/ Pseudoephedrine trafficking is done mainly through Delhi, Chennai, Cochin Airports.
- Instances of use of courier/ parcels also have been noticed.

Significant seizures of Ephedrine / Pseudoephedrine / Acetic Anhydride:

- From 31.03.2023 to 03.04.2023, Officers of NCB, Ahmedabad Zonal Unit seized 39,60,000 capsules (475.2 kg) of Pseudoephedrine at S-3 Godown, Port CFS, APM Terminal, Pipavav Port, District-Amreli, Gujarat.
- On 25.04.2023, Officers of NCB, Delhi Zonal Unit seized 4.927 kg of Pseudoephedrine at DHL Exp. Pvt. Ltd. Rama Road, Kriti Nagar, New Delhi.
- On 04.07.2023, Officers of NCB, Mumbai Zonal Unit seized 3.87 kg of Pseudoephedrine at Aramax Couriers, Andheri, Mumbai.
- On 25.09.2023, Officers of NCB, Mumbai Zonal Unit seized 49.880 kg Pseudoephedrine at Mumbai.

CASE STUDY-08

Name of the Drug : Pseudoephedrine

Qty. Seized : 39,60,000 capsules Pseudoephedrine

NCB Zonal Unit : Ahmedabad Zonal Unit

Total Arrest: 02 Persons

- Acting upon a specific input, a team of officials of Narcotics Control Bureau, Ahmedabad had searched a container bearing no. TCLU5702630 at Pipavav Port and took batch wise samples (in triplicate) of medicines claimed/suspected to be containing Pseudoephedrine. The first sample of each batch was sent to National Forensic Science University, Gandhinagar (NFSU) for chemical analysis.
- Since the intelligence regarding diversion of pseudoephedrine was found correct as per the NFSU report, a team of NCB Ahmedabad carried out seizure procedure of medicines contained in said container bearing no. TCLU5702630 and seized fake capsules of Pseudoephedrine totaling to 3960000 nos. As per declaration, each capsule was supposed to contain 120 mg of pseudoephedrine HCL and in this manner diversion of 475.2 kg of Pseudoephedrine HCL was prima facie unearthed in this operation
- During the investigation, it was found that the said medicines were manufactured and being exported by M/s 'X' to South Sudan. In this connection, The Director, Authorized Chief Chemist and Store incharge of M/s 'X'were arrested for their involvement in the crime and contravention of provisions of Sections 9A, 25A, 26, 29 &38 of NDPS Act.




